



FREE GUIDE · FOR ACUPUNCTURE

The Acupuncture Clinic's Guide to Compliant Disposal.

One main stream — single-use needles — but
the volume adds up. Here's how to handle it.

DEA-REGISTERED

EPA-COMPLIANT

NO CONTRACT

CERTIFICATE OF DESTRUCTION

Compliance, made simple.

It's all about the needles.

Acupuncture generates essentially one regulated waste stream — single-use needles — but the volume adds up fast, and they are sharps that require compliant disposal, not the trash. This short guide covers needle disposal done right and the few other things that occasionally apply.

The good news

You don't need a hauler or a contract — prepaid mail-back sharps kits, sized to your treatment volume, with a Certificate of Destruction.

AT A GLANCE

Who regulates what.

Agency	What it covers in your practice
OSHA	Bloodborne Pathogens Standard — sharps handling, containers, and annual staff training.
EPA	RCRA — hazardous pharmaceutical waste identification, segregation, and destruction.
DEA	Controlled substances — non-retrievable destruction and DEA Form 41 documentation.
DOT	Safe shipping of regulated medical and pharmaceutical waste in transit.
State	Health-department and environmental rules that vary by state.

THE STREAMS

Every stream, in depth.

Below is each regulated stream your practice produces — what belongs in it, what does not, the rule behind it, how to dispose of it, and a tip to stay clean.

WASTE STREAM 01

Sharps

Single-use acupuncture needles — your primary and highest-volume stream.

GOES IN THIS STREAM

- Single-use acupuncture needles
- Press needles & intradermals
- Lancets (if used)

DOES NOT GO HERE

- Bloody gauze (biohazard)
- Expired meds (pharmaceutical)
- Non-sharp packaging

THE RULE · OSHA Bloodborne Pathogens Standard — FDA-cleared, puncture-resistant containers, no overfilling, annual training.

DISPOSE WITH · Sharps mail-back kit.

Tip

Replace containers at the fill line; keep them upright, closable, and out of reach.

WASTE STREAM 02

Biohazard / regulated medical waste

Cotton or gauze with visible blood.

GOES IN THIS STREAM

- Blood-spotted cotton balls / gauze
- Contaminated PPE
- Procedure waste (if any)

DOES NOT GO HERE

- Sharps (sharps kit)
- Lightly soiled everyday items
- Expired meds (pharmaceutical)

THE RULE · OSHA plus your state's medical-waste rules — red bags, labeling, treatment/destruction, retained documentation.

DISPOSE WITH · Biohazard mail-back kit.

Tip

Only visibly blood/OPIM-contaminated items are red-bag waste — check your state's definition.

YOUR CHECKLIST

The acupuncture compliance checklist.

- ☐ Every single-use needle placed in an FDA-cleared sharps container — never the trash.
- ☐ Containers sized and stocked to your treatment volume so they never overfill.
- ☐ Blood-spotted cotton or gauze red-bagged as biohazard when contaminated.

- ☐ Containers kept upright, closable, and out of patient reach.
- ☐ Basic sharps and bloodborne-pathogen safety understood by staff.
- ☐ Certificates of Destruction retained per your state's rules.

QUESTIONS ACUPUNCTURISTS ASK

Your acupuncture questions, answered.

How do we dispose of used acupuncture needles?

In an FDA-cleared sharps container, then a prepaid sharps mail-back kit. Never in the regular trash — even single-use filiform needles are regulated sharps.

We do a lot of treatments — how do we manage the volume?

We size your sharps kits to your treatment volume so you're never scrambling for space or overfilling a container.

Are blood-spotted cotton balls regulated?

Only when visibly blood-contaminated — then they're biohazard. Otherwise ordinary trash; check your state's definition.

Do we need a contract?

No — no contract, no minimums.

THE EASY WAY

Handle it with mail-back.

Easy Rx Cycle ships prepaid mail-back sharps kits sized to your treatment volume — used needles and any contaminated cotton — destroyed at our DEA-registered facility with a Certificate of Destruction. No contract.

QUICK REFERENCE · WHICH KIT FOR WHICH STREAM

Waste stream	The right path
Single-use needles	Sharps mail-back kit
Blood-spotted cotton / gauze	Biohazard mail-back kit



Prefer pickup, or higher volume?

Mail-back suits virtually every acupuncture clinic. High-volume or multi-practitioner? We'll size the kits — get a quote at easyrxcycle.com/get-a-quote or call 501-904-2929.

WHY ACUPUNCTURE CLINICS CHOOSE EASY RX CYCLE

- No contract, no minimums — buy as you need
- Flat-rate pricing — no fuel or hidden surcharges
- One vendor for every stream you generate
- DEA-registered, EPA- & OSHA-aligned destruction
- A Certificate of Destruction on every single order

Ready to simplify your acupuncture clinic waste?

Shop mail-back kits with prices, or get a custom quote for pickup and higher volume. No contract, cancel anytime.

501-904-2929 · sales@easyrxcycle.com · easyrxcycle.com/shop